

515 Gallagher St. (house)
Proposed Champion Historic District
Springfield
Clark County
Ohio

HABS No. OH-2453

HABS
OHIO
12-SPRIF,
16-

PHOTOGRAPHS

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

Historic American Buildings Survey
National Park Service
Great Lakes Systems Office
Department of the Interior
1709 Jackson St.
Omaha, Nebraska 68102

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY

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Location: 515 Gallagher St., Springfield, Clark County, Ohio

Significance: This house is a representative, intact example of an early post-Civil War house type that was once prevalent in the city. It survives with its original siding and decorative details largely intact and, except for its altered front porch and deteriorated condition, has a relatively high degree of integrity.

Description: The house is a long narrow building that is part of a closely spaced cluster of late 19th century houses within the proposed Champion Historic District. The house has a low rubble stone foundation and a basically rectangular ground plan. It is of balloon frame construction and has exterior walls that are covered with original drop siding. Windows have been boarded over, but are symmetrically arranged on the exterior and probably have one-over-one or two-over-two wood sash intact behind the wood panels. This narrow house is only two bays wide and is a full two stories in height. It has a full-width front porch with low-pitched hipped roof, although the porch posts and railing are of an extremely simple design that suggests they have been fairly recently changed. While the main doorway is along one side, the presence of a nearby side wall window suggests that this is not a Side Hallway house type, as it does not seem to have a stairway along the lateral wall. Instead, the front door probably opens into a single large room. A low-pitched hipped roof with broad overhanging eaves caps the building. Pairs of decorative brackets accent the front and sides of the building. To the rear is a one-story gabled wing with a corner porch that seems to have been recently enclosed. There is a center brick chimney.

History: This building was probably constructed in the 1880s, judging from its styling and materials. In 1915 it was home to Henry C. and Mary Aldridge. He was employed as a laborer, probably at a nearby factory. By 1916 it had other occupants, Karl and Augusta Stephens. He was an assistant foreman. From 1917-23 it was home to Edward and Mary Dundon. He worked as a laborer. From 1924-28 it was home to Charles and Harriet Lowry. He was a machinist. It has had a series of short-term occupants over the years, until 1987, when the house became vacant.

Sources: 1915 and later Springfield city directories. The building stands within the proposed Champion Historic District, which has been determined eligible by the Ohio State Historic Preservation Officer for listing on the National Register of Historic Places. Copies of information used to make this determination of eligibility for National Register status are at the Springfield Department of Planning and Development and the Ohio Historic Preservation Office.

Historian: Steven McQuillin, preservation consultant to the City of Springfield, 1997